Research Project Proposal

Title: Investigating Digital Parenting Practices and Media Habits of Digitods in Hong Kong

Introduction

The introduction of the iPhone in 2007 marked the birth of the digitods – a new generation of children born with readily available access to a wide range of touchscreen devices. With the development of mobile network technology and the advent of the streaming media era, digitods born after 2017 are inevitably exposed to digital screens from birth. In Hong Kong, an increasing number of parents rely on using digital devices for parenting. Given the decisive role of parents in parenting decisions and the close connection between the growth of digitods and digital screens, this study aims to investigate the background and usage of Hong Kong parents who conduct digital parenting, ultimately understanding the inherent link between the media habits of Hong Kong digitods and digital parenting practices. Based on the analysis of parents' behaviors and children's media habits, this study will provide significant references and guidance for the design of interaction forms and content of digital devices for preschool children.

Objectives:

- To what extent do the background factors of parents in Hong Kong influence their digital parenting practices?
- To what extent do the digital parenting practices of Hong Kong parents influence their preschool children's digital habits?
- To what extent do the digital habits of Hong Kong preschool children relate to their parents' background and digital parenting practices?

Methods:

This research will focus on children aged between 3 to 6 in Hong Kong to fit the definition of “digitods” and the new media trend and their parents. It will mainly adopt questionnaires for data collection and analysis. The sample size is estimated to be around 200 Hong Kong parents. Key data collected

will include three parts: parents' background factors (e.g. age, education attainment, employment status, family income per month), digital parenting practices (e.g. number of digital devices at home, hours spent with children, hours spent using digital devices for personal purposes while being by child's side, hours spent using digital devices together with child each day, purpose and context), and digital habits of Hong Kong preschool children (e.g. children self-use screen time and activities).

1. Sample Selection:

This research will primarily focus on digitods aged between 3 to 6 in Hong Kong and their parents. A representative sample of approximately 200 parents and their digitod children will be selected for the study.

2. Data Collection:

The experiment will select parents as participants through kindergartens and online channels. Each participant will fill in a 15-20 minute questionnaire, which collects basic background information, details about their digital parenting practices and digital habits of Hong Kong preschool children.

3. Data Analysis:

Data collected through questionnaires will be subjected to rigorous analysis. Quantitative data will be analyzed using statistical techniques.

Timeline:

Data Collection: start from 16th October to 4th Novenber]

Data Analysis: [4th Novenber to 15th Novenber]

Report Writing: [15th Novenber to 15th December]

Expected Outcomes:

This research project is expected to yield valuable insights into the digital parenting practices of Hong Kong parents and the media habits of digitods. The findings will contributing to an enhanced understanding of the evolving

relationship between technology, parenting, and childhood development. Furthermore, the results will serve as a basis for recommendations on the design of interactive digital media for preschool children.

Conclusion:

This research project aims to shed light on an emerging area of interest in child development and parenting by examining the practices and habits of digitods in Hong Kong. By investigating the interplay between digital parenting and media habits, we hope to offer practical guidance for parents, educators, and technology developers seeking to enhance the digital experiences of preschool children in a responsible and informed manner.

Moreover, our research may serve as a beacon for technology developers, inspiring them to create more responsible and child-centric digital experiences. By doing so, we can positively impact the lives of the youngest members of our society.